

The Principle of Shared Space

Joseph Shields

2026

Axiom

$$c^2 = c + 1$$

The unique positive solution is $\varphi = (1 + \sqrt{5})/2$, giving contraction rate $r = 1/(2\varphi) \approx 0.3090$.

1 Introduction

Shared space is the foundation upon which the very fabric of reality is built. Space-time emerges from the infinite possibility of light updating topological information, contorted by the probability of matter.

$$\begin{array}{ll} \text{Light:} & (1 - r)^2 & = 0.4775 \\ \text{Matter:} & r^2 & = 0.0955 \end{array}$$

This contortion produces the boundary channel — the structural boundary within which our visible universe resides.

$$\text{Boundary: } 2r(1 - r) = 0.4271$$

A forced relationship of simplicity along one initial axis: the axis of acknowledgement.

2 The Axis of Acknowledgement

Acknowledgement is the core of Unified Mechanics. Not just in terms of what acknowledgement is, but how, over time, even the simplest recognition of two states

can give rise to complex relationships. Even the most naive or ignorant forms of acknowledgement can generate intricate boundaries and deeply layered structures.

The early universe is the clearest expression of this principle in action. The cosmic soup of that time was a hot, dense field of overcomplex geometry — light and matter so intertwined they were effectively indistinguishable. No distinct relationships had yet formed. But as expansion progressed, the uncoupled, overcomplex geometry of matter stretched and cooled. At a certain threshold the temperature dropped far enough that electrons and protons could finally hold each other. Matter became neutral for the first time. And in that moment the universe went from opaque to transparent — light, which had until then scattered off every charged surface it touched, was suddenly free. It flooded outward in every direction at once, carrying the first complete impression of what the universe looked like. We still receive that light today. It is the oldest thing we can see.

3 The Axis of Exploration

Spacetime, as a three-dimensional structure, allows full spherical freedom of traversal from any origin — complete freedom to expand along whatever path least action deemed most viable for the intended direction of its boundaries. This gave rise to distinct temperature and pressure gradients, continuously complexifying the boundaries.

From the distance between the highest peaks and the lowest valleys, density found its weight. Gravity followed that weight inward, and the first stars ignited — enormous, brief, and violent. In their cores they forged elements that had never existed, and when they died they scattered them across the void in events so vast the debris became the raw material for entirely new worlds. On at least one of those worlds, the same recursion found a new medium. Chemistry took up where geometry had left off — organising, replicating, complexifying through the same underlying pressure that had always driven it. From that came life. And from life, given enough time and enough boundary to push against, the full bewildering complexity of a human being.

Just as humans spend entire lifetimes building toward highly specific fields, the universe explored every dimension available to it. Moving into a new space demands adaptation at the very least, and in more extreme cases, complete restructuring. Life presents a myriad of possibilities, each more complex than the last. Yet one unalienable truth remains: all human problems are inherently human. They always carry the shape of human society within them. We simply do not know any different.

4 The Axis of Familiarity

A hydrogen atom will not spontaneously become moscovium under normal conditions. Moscovium can, however, be synthesised under precise laboratory constraints. In the same way, a gorilla can be made comfortable within a zoo enclosure — the familiar environment carefully simulated to meet its needs. The conditions of both the entity and its native environment must be satisfied for stability to emerge.

This is the final complex relationship the universe had to traverse. Once probability had solidified its influence on existence — narrowing down what could be into what will be — the universe arrived not at an ending, but at a settling. Each thing becoming, at last, what it always had the conditions to become.

And what remains is the intricate reflection of what is.

From individual grains of sand on a beach to exoplanets at the edge of perception, we all share in this intricate relationship within a place we simply call space.

The three axes map directly onto the three channels of $c^2 = c + 1$:

Axis	Channel	Weight
Acknowledgement	Boundary	$2r(1 - r) = 0.4271$
Exploration	Light	$(1 - r)^2 = 0.4775$
Familiarity	Matter	$r^2 = 0.0955$

The boundary channel and these three axes compose reality. The intricate web of information that occupies spacetime.